



Note: It can also work with 512 MB of RAM but that's recommended only when the host machine has 2 GB, or less, of RAM.

- **Hard drive:** Select the **Use an existing virtual hard drive file** option and specify the location of the extracted Chromium OS VDI file and press **Create**.
- **Settings configuration:** Before starting the Chromium OS VM, the following settings need to be in place:
 - **Enable Physical Address Extension:** Navigate to **Settings > System > Processor** and check **Enable PAE/NX**
 - **Network adapter type:** Navigate to **Settings > Network > Adapter 1 > Advanced** and change the adapter type to **Intel PRO/1000 MT Desktop (82540EM)**

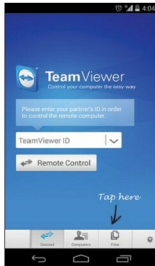


Figure 7: Accessing the shared folder on an Android device

Executing the VM

In the VirtualBox console, select **Chromium OS** and press **Start** from the top menu.

On starting, the VM window will show the notifications regarding **Auto capture keyboard** and **Mouse Pointer Integration** stating that the VM supports these features and they have been turned on by default.

For some reason, the mouse integration doesn't work well with **Chromium OS VM**, so we'll need to disable it for the mouse pointer to work in the VM environment. Do so by selecting **Disable Mouse Pointer Integration** from the **Machine** menu in the VM window. The next time you click inside the VM window, the pop-up shown in Figure 9 will appear.

Check **Do not show this message again** and press **Capture**.

Chromium OS

On the first run, Chromium OS will require you to specify certain settings for it to work. Once the configuration is complete, you'll be shown the welcome screen.

Congratulations! You're now the proud owner of a virtual Chromebook. To explore more, visit the official **Chromebook Help** website at <http://goo.gl/Lz2aBC>.

Apart from running other OSs, there are several uses to which a VirtualBox can be put.

Use-case 3: Run legacy applications and operating systems

In the course of a day's work, one may come across applications which will only run on a particular configuration.

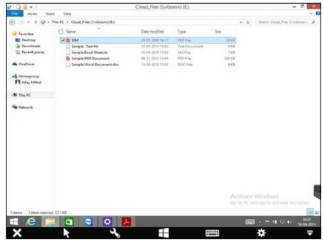


Figure 8: Accessing the VM on an Apple iPad

For example, even today, there are many Web-based applications that can only run on Internet Explorer 6. These configurations might be obsolete (just like IE 6) and can be hard to find in a production environment.

Apart from these, there could be times when a vendor stops supporting a version of an operating system, and since organisations cannot make a switch easily, they will be stuck. One recent example is Microsoft withdrawing support for Windows XP.

In situations like these, VirtualBox can be of great help. Create a VM of that particular configuration or operating system and move on with life. These VMs can be used till the applications are ported to a newer configuration or OS, and then can be discarded.

Use-case 4: Test suspicious files

Let's assume that you've got an email from a friend that has an attachment, but you're feeling a bit sceptical about it. Why take a risk by opening it on your system? Use VirtualBox. Create a master VM, clone it and open the attachment on the clone. Once you're sure about the integrity of the file, discard the clone. This setup can also come in handy if you like to study or experiment with computer viruses. You can unleash the virus on one of the clones and then study its effect on it—all the fun without compromising the security of the host system.

Use-case 5: Set up a multi-platform development environment

VirtualBox can be a real boon for application and Web developers. Using VirtualBox, they can set up a development environment comprising various platforms (servers, Windows, Linux, Solaris, etc) and with the help of the shared folders feature, a central repository of code can be set up. This code can then be tested on different platforms. This saves you the trouble of setting up a physical lab and then replicating code on each of the systems.